

METHODOLOGY · 2026

The New Talent Acquisition *Operating Model*

The methodology behind a new talent acquisition process

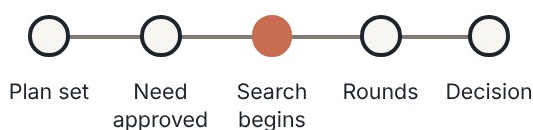
WEITA IN THREE SENTENCES

- 1 WeiTA is a strategic talent acquisition partner bringing a new, business-led talent acquisition operating model to organisations, and helping them adopt it.
- 2 The model moves hiring from transactional, requisition-based activity to a standing, evergreen talent ecosystem, through an approach WeiTA calls Attract, Engage and Convert.
- 3 The process is re-architected around the business; the people (your TA team and partners) stay at the centre.

TWO WAYS TO HIRE

REQUISITION-LED

Hiring that starts with a requisition *reacts* to the plan.



THE BUSINESS WAITS

STANDING ECOSYSTEM

Hiring that runs as a standing ecosystem is *ready* for it.



READY WHEN THE PLAN MOVES

THINK OF IT AS *buying parts only when the production line stops, against a supplier network that is ready before the order.*

BY THE NUMBERS

The cost of waiting lands on *the business*, and on each role in it

59%

of GCC leaders say talent gaps delayed launches, projects or go-to-market plans



CEO

The plan moves in quarters. When launches wait on talent, the plan waits too.

56%

report higher external vendor costs



CFO

Spend rises on agencies and portals, and builds nothing the organisation keeps.

54%

say talent gaps limit their AI and digital programmes



HIRING MANAGER

The teams building what comes next wait for the people to build it.

45%

report wage inflation beyond budget



CHRO

Pay is left to compete where employer brand and experience could.

THE PROBLEMS LEADERS DESCRIBE · 2025-2026

What talent leaders, CHROs and hiring managers *tell us*

👤 The specialists sit outside the funnel

Volume is handled. The top specialists in AI, product and health technology stay out of reach.

🔄 AI is talking to AI

Résumés shaped by AI, screened by AI. Each side reads an enhanced version of the other.

⏸ The freeze problem

Roles pause. The team must stay productive, and what it built must stay engaged.

🔄 The relay

Task, role, job description, partners, shortlist. Meaning thins at every handoff.

👥 Panel fatigue

Leaders spend hours interviewing people who were never the right fit.

🕒 Decisions against the clock

Leaders meet talent last, and choose under time pressure.

👁 A new capability, no yardstick

Building AI or a new domain, leaders have no internal benchmark for great.

🏠 The shift they asked for

A permanent structure. Chosen as an employer before a role opens.

THINK OF IT AS *scaffolding: put up for every role, taken down after it, and built again for the next.*

WHERE THE OLD MODEL BREAKS

It was built for a market where good people applied, signals were honest and the business could wait. That market has changed. Between a business need and a decision, it leaks at seven points:

- | | |
|--|--|
| <p>1 Talent acquisition starts when the need does</p> | <p>2 Critical roles wait, and growth waits with them</p> |
| <p>3 The passive professionals it needs never see the organisation</p> | <p>4 Volume rises and signal falls: AI screens AI</p> |
| <p>5 Each handoff in the relay loses meaning</p> | <p>6 Funnel decay: interest fades between stages</p> |
| <p>7 Talent acquisition is kept operational, away from strategy</p> | |

FROM PROBLEM TO MODEL

Every failure point *has an answer*

The answer is a different operating model. It builds the organisation's own standing, evergreen talent ecosystem and runs it in three stages: **Attract**, who you can reach; **Engage**, who knows you; **Convert**, who joins you.



	THE FAILURE POINT	WHAT THE NEW MODEL DOES	STAGE
1	Talent acquisition starts when the need does	→ Work begins with the business plan, before any requisition.	ATTRACT
2	Critical roles wait	→ A standing talent community exists for each critical capability, engaged and ready when the budget is approved.	ENGAGE
3	Unseen by passive professionals	→ Professionals meet the leaders and the real work long before they are asked to apply.	ENGAGE
4	Volume up, signal down	→ Entry is curated, and people are judged on live work, in conversation.	ATTRACT
5	Meaning lost in the relay	→ Leaders meet professionals directly, early, with nothing in between.	CONVERT
6	Funnel decay	→ Engagement stays continuous, and decisions close while everything is fresh.	CONVERT
7	Kept away from strategy	→ The TA leader joins the planning table, with market intelligence in hand.	ALL THREE

THINK OF IT AS *moving from renting to owning. Every search rents attention from the market; an ecosystem builds equity the organisation keeps.*

HOW THE MODEL WORKS

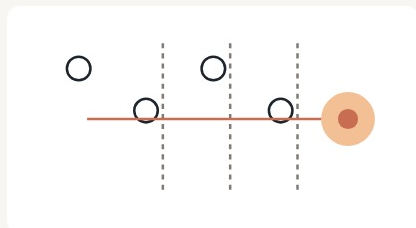
Three stages, running *all year*

Each stage runs continuously and builds on the last. The organisation's leaders and practitioners lead; WeiTA designs and runs it with the TA team.

WHO YOU CAN REACH

Attract

Know who you need, before you need them



WHAT WEITA DOES

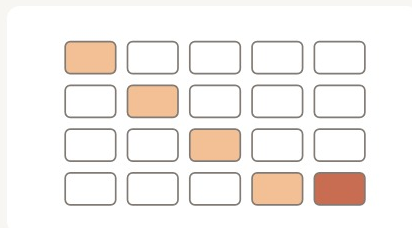
Maps where the capability sits, starting from the business plan

Invites the right professionals into the organisation's own talent community, verified on real work

WHO KNOWS YOU

Engage

Stay in the conversation between roles



WHAT WEITA DOES

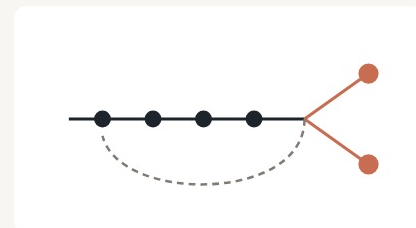
Runs a steady engagement calendar across twelve formats

Puts leaders and practitioners in front of the professionals the plan needs

WHO JOINS YOU

Convert

Turn engagement into decisions



WHAT WEITA DOES

Designs each Talent Connect room and its conversion strategy

Closes decisions while they are fresh

WHAT THE ORGANISATION GETS

Passive professionals attracted and reached

Leadership access to the talent market

Faster time to hire, with decision conviction

Market intelligence on where the capability sits

The right EVP, shaped with the market

Higher offer-to-join

A talent asset the organisation owns

An employer brand experienced first-hand

Train and deploy for early career

THINK OF IT AS *the commercial engine the business already runs: marketing attracts, account management engages, sales converts, all year.*

ENGAGE · TWELVE FORMATS, EACH WITH A JOB · NEVER DAILY

01 Publications and field notes

02 Leadership videos

03 Leadership AMA: open questions to leaders

04 Podcast with practitioners

05 Skill sessions and deep dives

06 Organisation briefings

07 Hackathons on live problems

08 Gamified coding and problem-solving challenges

09 Meetups and roundtables, virtual and in person

10 Innovation pitch and ideas expo, direct to leaders

11 Speed mentoring and referral programmes

12 Recognition spotlight, chosen by peers

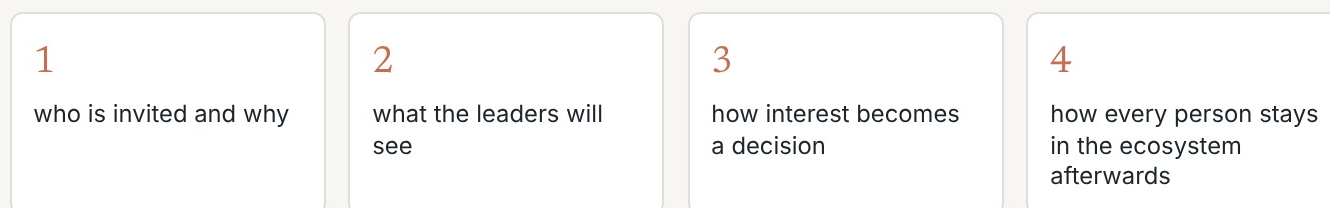
— INSIDE CONVERT

The Talent Connect *room*

One day. Curated professionals and the people who actually decide, working on a live business problem. Leaders see how professionals think, collaborate and handle ambiguity, on the organisation's own work.



EVERY ROOM CARRIES A CONVERSION STRATEGY · FOUR QUESTIONS ANSWERED BEFORE ANYONE IS INVITED



WHAT THE ORGANISATION GETS · THE RESULTS MAP

Hiring decisions

- Direct hiring, decided on real work
- Decision conviction
- Culture fit observed in how people work together
- Faster time to hire
- Higher offer-to-join

Employer brand

- Employer brand experienced first-hand
- The right EVP, shaped with the market
- Passive professionals attracted
- Employer of first choice
- Market impressions from every room

Leaders and the business

- Leadership access to the talent market
- Market intelligence: who is out there and what they expect
- Capability ready when the plan moves
- A talent asset the organisation owns

Integrity and trust

- Authentic evaluation on live work
- A direct line of sight for leaders

The professionals

- Learning from practitioners
- Mentoring and recognition
- Career clarity and a first look at opportunities
- Train and deploy for early career
- Referrals and advocacy

THINK OF IT AS *an investor pitch day: the decision-makers, one real problem, one room, and a decision made the same day.*

TAKEAWAY A room without a conversion strategy is an event. A room with one is a decision forum, and every result it creates, hired or not, stays with the organisation.

— ONE NEED, START TO FINISH

One platform team, *from plan to decision*

An illustration of how the model runs, not a case study.

THINK OF IT AS *a product launch planned from the roadmap, well before the launch date is fixed.*

The plan

An organisation's plan for the coming year includes a new platform engineering capability. Under the traditional model, the first requisition would be raised when the budget is approved, and the search would begin from zero.

Attract

Instead, the TA team sits with the business when the plan is being shaped. Together they define the capability in working terms (the problems the team will solve, not a list of keywords) and map where those engineers work, write and gather. Invitations go out to professionals who would never have applied: a conversation with the organisation's architects, a look at the real platform, a place among peers. Each person who joins passes the entry checks and the three gates.

Engage

Over the following weeks, the cadence runs. A practitioner session on the organisation's architecture. A leader's short video on why the platform matters. A peer roundtable. A monthly Build Day on a real problem from the platform roadmap. The TA team watches who contributes, who refers others and who asks about the work.

Convert

When the budget is approved, the organisation does not start a search; it starts a conversation. A Talent Connect room is planned with a clear conversion strategy: who is invited, what the leaders want to see, and how decisions will be closed. On the day, working groups take on a live platform problem; leaders hold one-to-one conversations; the decision forum meets while everything is fresh; the bridge closes decisions into offers.

After the room

Some professionals join. Others are not right for this role, or not ready to move, and they stay in the ecosystem, still engaged. When the next platform role opens, the organisation already knows who to call.

What the business noticed

Leaders met talent directly instead of last. The employer brand was experienced, not advertised. And the capability was ready closer to when the plan needed it.

TAKEAWAY In the new model, approving the budget is not the start of a search. It is the start of a decision, with people the organisation already knows.

SIX ROLES

How each role changes in *the new operating model*

Titles remain the same. Each role returns to the part of the work only it can do.

ROLE	WHAT THE CURRENT MODEL ASKS	WHAT THE NEW MODEL GIVES
 CEO	A business plan that moves faster than hiring can	Talent ready when the plan moves
 CFO	Talent spend spread across vacancies, agencies and portals	Talent investment in an ecosystem the organisation keeps
 CHRO	Being held to time-to-fill instead of workforce outcomes	A seat in shaping the workforce strategy with the board
 TA leader	Being pulled into requisition operations	The role of front door to the talent market
 Hiring manager	Time lost in repeated interview rounds	Decisions made on real work
 Recruiter	Time lost to portals, volume and chasing	The role of the organisation's face to the talent market

THINK OF IT AS *an orchestra with a new score: the same musicians, each playing the part only they can.*

WHO DOES WHAT

The organisation

owns the decisions and the ecosystem

The business plan and the capabilities it needs

Every hiring decision and offer

The ecosystem itself: it stays with the organisation

WeiTA, with the TA team

designs and runs the model

Mapping the capability and curating the community

Running the engagement calendar and each Talent Connect room

Bringing back talent intelligence

The professionals

bring themselves and their work

Contribute to real problems and refer peers

Decide for themselves whether and when to move

Gain learning, access and recognition

— SELF-CHECK

Where does your talent acquisition *stand*?

Score each: 0 not yet · 1 partly · 2 consistently

1	Talent acquisition is involved when the business plan is being set.	☐	☐	☐
2	We know where the professionals for our critical capabilities work today.	☐	☐	☐
3	We have an engaged community for at least one critical capability, before roles open.	☐	☐	☐
4	Professionals experience our leaders and real work before they are asked to apply.	☐	☐	☐
5	Our engagement with the market runs on a steady cadence.	☐	☐	☐
6	Our leaders meet professionals early in the process.	☐	☐	☐
7	Our evaluation includes real work done live.	☐	☐	☐
8	We stay in active contact with every professional through to joining.	☐	☐	☐
9	People we did not hire stay engaged with us for future roles.	☐	☐	☐
10	We measure talent acquisition by readiness and decision quality.	☐	☐	☐

0–7 · Requisition-led

Begin with one capability, one quarter.

8–14 · In transition

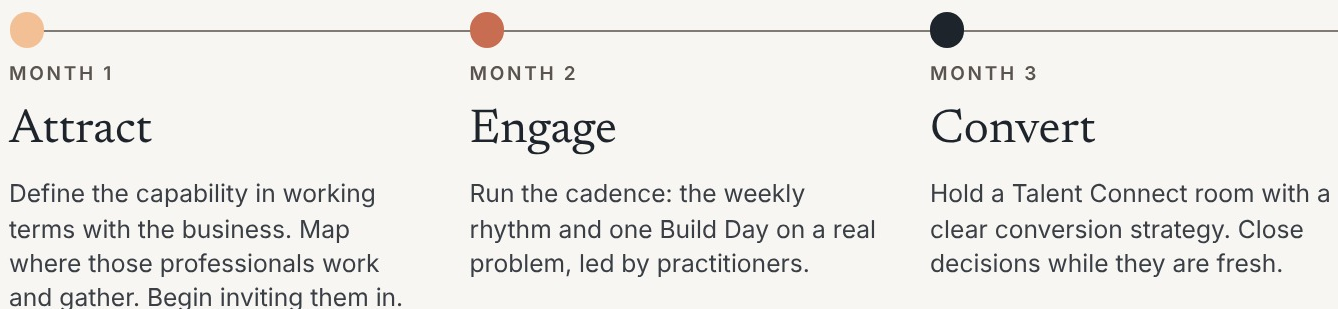
Connect what exists with a cadence.

15–20 · Ecosystem-led

Extend to more capabilities.

THINK OF IT AS *a pilot plant before the full factory: one capability, one quarter, proven before it scales.*

— WHERE TO BEGIN

One capability. One quarter. *One room.*

Then review with the business. Measure it beyond time-to-fill: readiness, decision quality, efficiency, brand and trust, and the intelligence the market returns.

Sources: PwC India and FICCI, Aug 2026 · Zinnov-nasscom, FY2026 · People Matters, Aug 2026 · WeiTA field notes 2025–26, anonymised.



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